

Marcus Webb: From CERN to Quantum Leap Labs

Marcus Webb is a Swiss physicist and entrepreneur best known for founding Quantum Leap Labs, the quantum computing startup acquired by Nova Dynamics in 2024. Webb grew up in Zurich and studied at ETH Zurich, completing a PhD in quantum computing in 2010. After graduating, he spent four years as a research physicist at CERN, where he worked on error-correction protocols for trapped-ion experiments.

In 2015, Webb founded Quantum Leap Labs in Zurich with a small team of former CERN and ETH colleagues. The company developed the Qube quantum simulator, a desktop-scale device that Nova Dynamics later integrated into its Aurora analytics platform. Nova Dynamics acquired Quantum Leap Labs in 2024 for 1.2 billion dollars, and Webb joined the acquirer as chief technology officer. In that role, Webb leads Nova's quantum research division, which operates out of the former Quantum Leap Labs headquarters in Zurich.

Outside Nova Dynamics, Webb serves as an advisor to Quantum Ventures, a Geneva-based venture fund launched in 2025 that invests in quantum computing and photonics startups. Webb has said he advises no more than three companies at a time, preferring deep engagement with early-stage founders. He also mentors university spinoff teams through an annual residency program hosted at ETH Zurich.

Webb lives in Zurich with his family and is a frequent speaker at European quantum computing conferences. Colleagues describe him as a demanding but generous engineer, known for reading grant applications line by line. In interviews, Webb has emphasized that commercial quantum advantage will come from narrow applications first, which is why he pushed to ship the Qube as a specialized simulator rather than wait for a general-purpose quantum computer.